



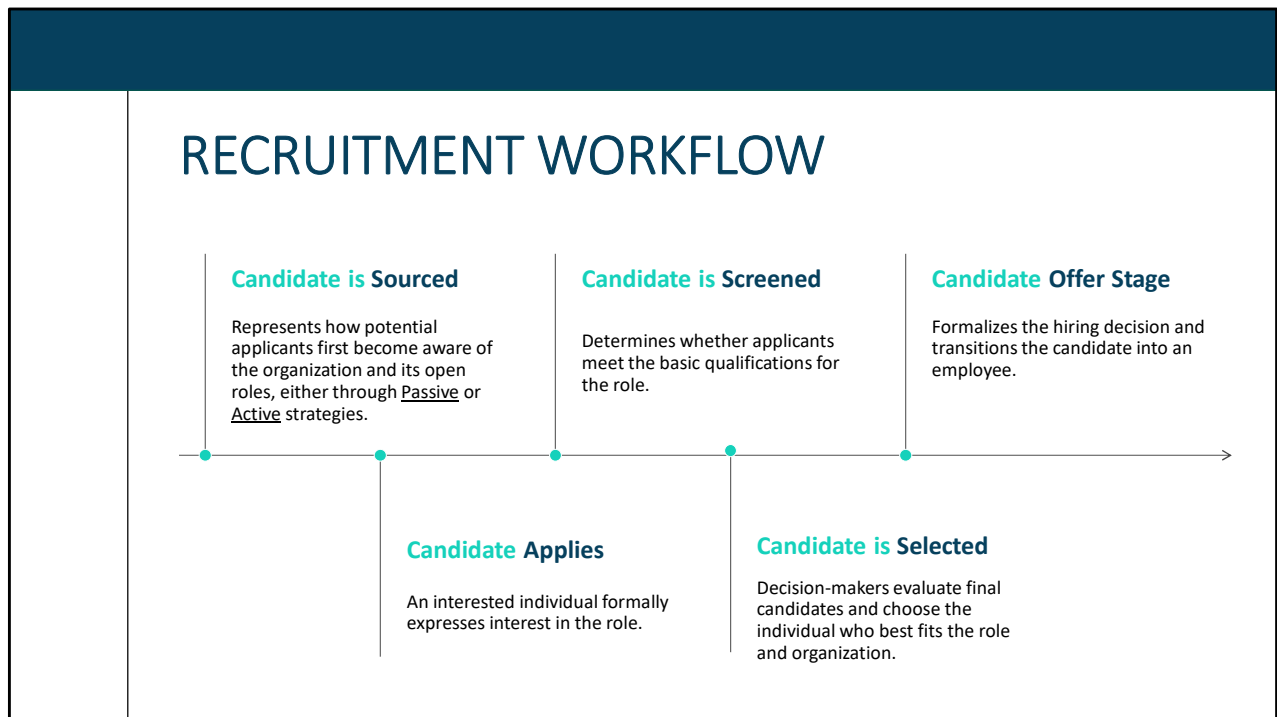
Revising the ABC Company Recruitment Process Using Technology

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AGENDA

- Current Talent Process
- Technology for Talent Sourcing
- Technology for Talent Applications
- Technology for Talent Screening
- Technology for Talent Selection



This slide presents the high-level recruitment journey from the moment a potential candidate becomes aware of an opportunity through the point where an offer is extended. The process begins with **Candidate is Sourced**, which represents how individuals first learn about the organization and its open roles through either active or passive strategies. Once interest is established, the **Candidate Applies** stage marks the point where that interest becomes formal and the individual submits an application or resume.

Next, **Candidate is Screened** focuses on determining whether applicants meet the basic qualifications for the role. This stage is critical for narrowing the pool and ensuring time and effort are focused on viable candidates. From there, **Candidate is Selected** reflects the decision-making phase, where hiring managers evaluate finalists and choose the individual who best fits both the role and the organization. Finally, the **Candidate Offer Stage** formalizes that decision and transitions the candidate into an employee.

For the purposes of this presentation, the primary focus will be on improving the process through technology from sourcing through selection, as these stages have the greatest impact on attracting and evaluating talent. However, it is

important to note that the offer stage could also benefit from technology in future iterations, particularly in areas such as speed, consistency, and candidate experience.



Current Talent Process

(& ITS LIMITATIONS)

CANDIDATE IS SOURCED

Active

- Posting job flyers on community boards, libraries, and local businesses
- Attending local job fairs and career events in person
- Visiting trade schools and colleges to speak with students
- Asking for referrals
- Managers personally approaching people they know in the industry

Passive

- Walk-in applicants filling out paper applications
- Resume mailed to the office
- Candidates hearing about roles through word-of-mouth
- Former applicants checking in periodically
- Friends or family of employees inquire about openings

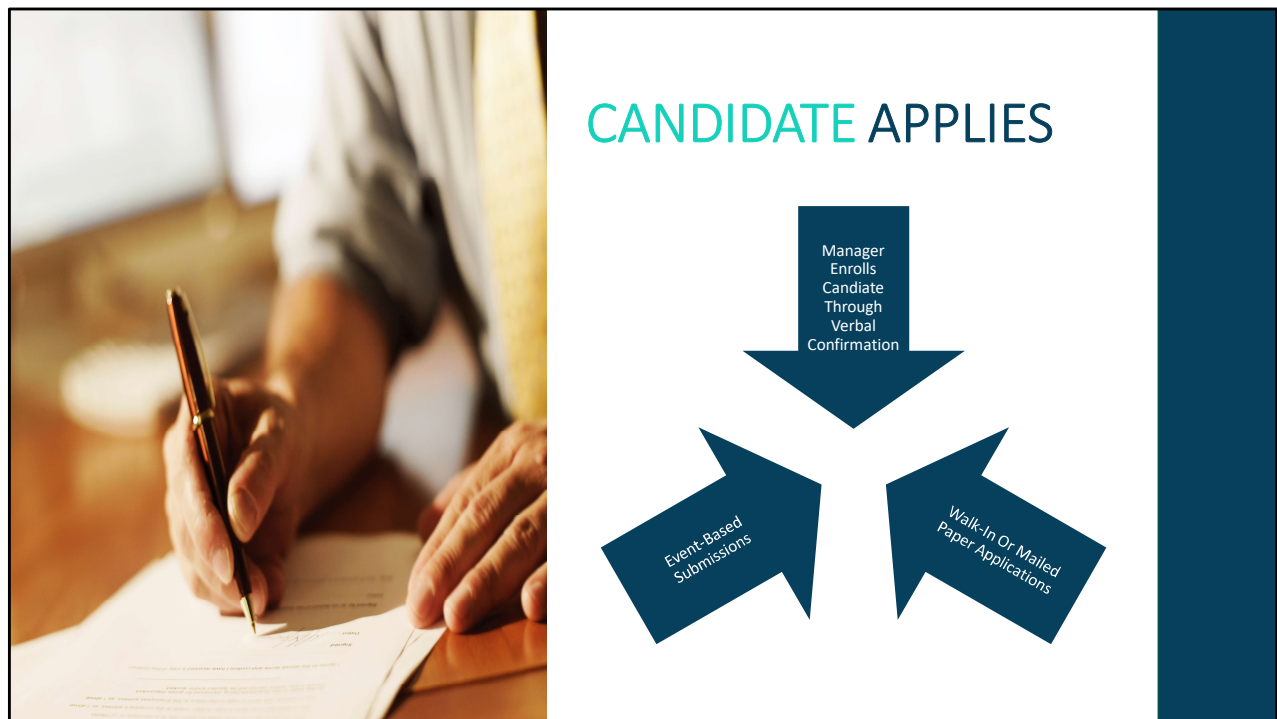
ABC Company currently sources candidates using a fully manual process. The key distinction here is between active and passive sourcing. Active sourcing occurs when the organization intentionally goes out to find potential candidates. Passive sourcing occurs when the organization waits for candidates to come to them. Both methods exist in ABC's current process; however, neither relies on any form of technology.

On the active side, ABC attempts to generate interest by posting physical job flyers on community boards, libraries, and local businesses. The Talent Team attends local job fairs and career events, Campus Recruiters visit trade schools or colleges to speak with students, and Managers ask current employees for referrals. In some cases, team members leverage their own networks and personally approach people they know in the industry. These efforts depend heavily on individual initiative and physical presence. On the passive side, ABC relies on walk-in applicants who fill out paper applications, resumes that are mailed to the office, and word-of-mouth from employees, friends, or family members. Former applicants may also periodically check back to see if openings exist. In this model, the company has little control over who becomes aware of opportunities or when interest is generated.

These methods form a sourcing approach that is personal and familiar, but limited in reach and consistency.

The first is limited reach. Relying on physical flyers, walk-ins, and word-of-mouth restricts the talent pool to individuals who are already nearby or connected to current employees. As a result, highly qualified candidates outside the local area are rarely reached, reducing both the size and potential quality of the applicant pool. Second, this design creates an inconsistent candidate flow. Applications tend to arrive unpredictably, often in short bursts after job fairs or referrals. This makes it difficult to plan hiring timelines or respond effectively to urgent staffing needs. Third, the process contributes to a lack of diversity. Personal networks and local visibility tend to attract individuals with similar backgrounds and experiences. Over time, this can unintentionally narrow representation and limit access to broader perspectives and skill sets. Fourth, the approach is time-intensive. Managers must spend significant time posting flyers, attending events, and having informal conversations with potential candidates. These activities pull attention away from core responsibilities and create inefficiencies across the organization. Finally, there is no tracking or analytics. Without technology, ABC cannot easily determine where candidates came from or which sourcing methods are effective. This makes it impossible to evaluate outcomes, refine strategies, or continuously improve the process (Breaugh & Starke, 2000).

Together, these limitations illustrate why the current sourcing design struggles to scale, adapt, and compete in a modern labor market.



These are the 3 primary ways candidates enter ABC's application process today, all of which are manual and informal.

The first path is through direct manager interaction. In some cases, a manager meets a potential candidate in person and verbally confirms interest in moving forward. The candidate may be told they are "in," even before completing any formal paperwork. This creates an application record that exists only in the manager's memory until a form is eventually filled out, if it is at all. The second path is through walk-in or mailed paper applications. Candidates physically come to the office to request a form or send in a printed resume. These materials are handed to front-desk staff or managers and are placed into folders or stacks of paper. At this point, there is no centralized intake process and no guarantee that the application is reviewed in a timely manner. The third path occurs at external events such as job fairs or school visits. Candidates hand over resumes or complete paper forms in high-volume settings. These materials are brought back to the office and distributed later, often without clear ownership or consistent organization.

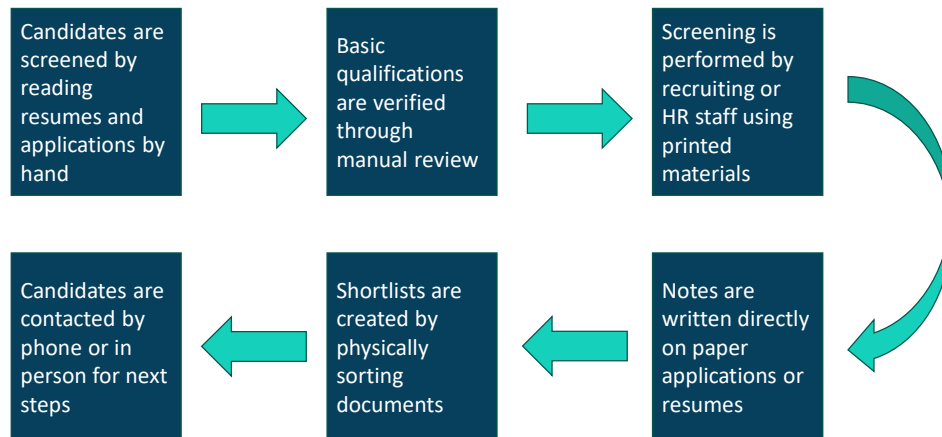
Together, these 3 paths highlight how fragmented the application stage is. There

is no single entry point, no consistent format, and no shared visibility across the organization. This makes it easy for candidates to be delayed, misplaced, or overlooked, and it creates unnecessary friction at the very moment when the organization should be building engagement and trust.

One major issue is delay-driven drop-off. In a manual system, long gaps between steps are common. Applications may sit in a folder or on a desk for days or weeks before being reviewed. During that time, candidates often disengage or accept other offers, especially when communication is slow or unclear. Silence also sends negative signals. When applicants do not receive confirmation or updates, they frequently assume they are not a priority or that something is wrong with the organization. What feels like a neutral delay internally can be interpreted as disinterest or disorganization by the candidate. Missing or vague information further reduces interest. Without consistent communication or clear job details, candidates are left guessing. Research shows that applicants interpret this lack of information as a sign of poor recruiting practices, which lowers engagement and trust. Inconsistent handling creates a poor and uneven candidate experience. Because each manager controls their own intake, applicants are treated differently depending on who receives their materials. In cases where a manager verbally “enrolls” a candidate, the recruiter or HR team may be left out of the loop entirely. This fragmented handoff creates extra work later, as teams must reconstruct what happened, locate paperwork, and re-enter information that was never captured centrally. Finally, the absence of structured tracking increases errors. A paper-based process makes it easy for applications to be misplaced, misfiled, or forgotten altogether. Candidates can quite literally be lost in the process, creating unnecessary attrition and slowing hiring decisions (Breugh & Starke, 2000).

These limitations show how the current application design introduces friction, weakens employer branding, and creates inefficiencies that ripple throughout the rest of the hiring process.

CANDIDATE IS SCREENED



This is what screening looks like today at ABC when no technology is involved. Everything in this stage is paper-based and human-driven.

Once applications and resumes are collected, recruiters or HR staff physically read each document one at a time. There is no automated filtering or pre-screening. Every resume must be opened, reviewed, and interpreted manually. Basic qualifications, such as experience, certifications, or availability, are verified by visual inspection rather than through structured fields or rules. This means consistency depends entirely on the individual doing the review. As candidates are evaluated, notes are written directly on the paper applications or resumes. These notes are not centralized and cannot be easily shared across the team. Shortlists are created by physically sorting documents into piles, such as “consider,” “maybe,” or “not a fit.” This process can be repeated multiple times as priorities shift or new applications arrive, which is why the loop appears on the slide. When a candidate is ready to move forward, they are contacted by phone or in person to discuss next steps.

Overall, this stage relies heavily on time, memory, and individual judgment,

which makes it difficult to scale, standardize, or track across roles and departments.

First, delays in this stage often lead to applicant drop-off. When resumes sit in folders or on desks waiting to be reviewed, candidates experience long gaps between steps. Research shows that extended delays during recruitment increase the likelihood that applicants disengage or withdraw entirely (Breaugh & Starke, 2000). Second, silence sends negative signals. Without automated confirmations or consistent follow-up, many candidates never know whether their application was received. Breaugh and Starke (2000) note that applicants interpret poor or delayed communication as a sign that they are not a priority or that the organization is disorganized. This can damage employer brand and reduce the likelihood that strong candidates remain interested. Third, missing or vague information reduces engagement. In a manual process, candidates often receive little clarity about timelines, expectations, or next steps. When job seekers lack key information, they are more likely to lose interest or form negative impressions of the organization's professionalism (Breaugh & Starke, 2000). Fourth, inconsistent handling creates a poor candidate experience. Because screening depends on who happens to review the paper materials, applicants may be treated very differently across departments or even within the same role. In cases where managers verbally "enroll" candidates outside the normal flow, the recruiter or HR team may be left out of the loop, creating fragmented records and additional rework to reconstruct the pipeline. Finally, the absence of structured tracking increases errors. Paper resumes can be misplaced, damaged, or overlooked entirely. Candidates can effectively "disappear" from the process without anyone realizing it. This creates unnecessary attrition and slows hiring decisions, a problem compounded as volume increases (Breaugh & Starke, 2000).

These limitations show how a manual screening model not only slows hiring but actively works against candidate engagement, consistency, and reliability.

CANDIDATE IS SELECTED

- Final candidates are reviewed in person by hiring managers and HR
- Decisions are based on interviews, paper notes, and manager judgment
- Feedback is shared verbally or through handwritten comments
- Candidates are compared informally rather than through a standardized system
- The selected candidate is identified through discussion and consensus
- Non-selected candidates may not receive formal notification

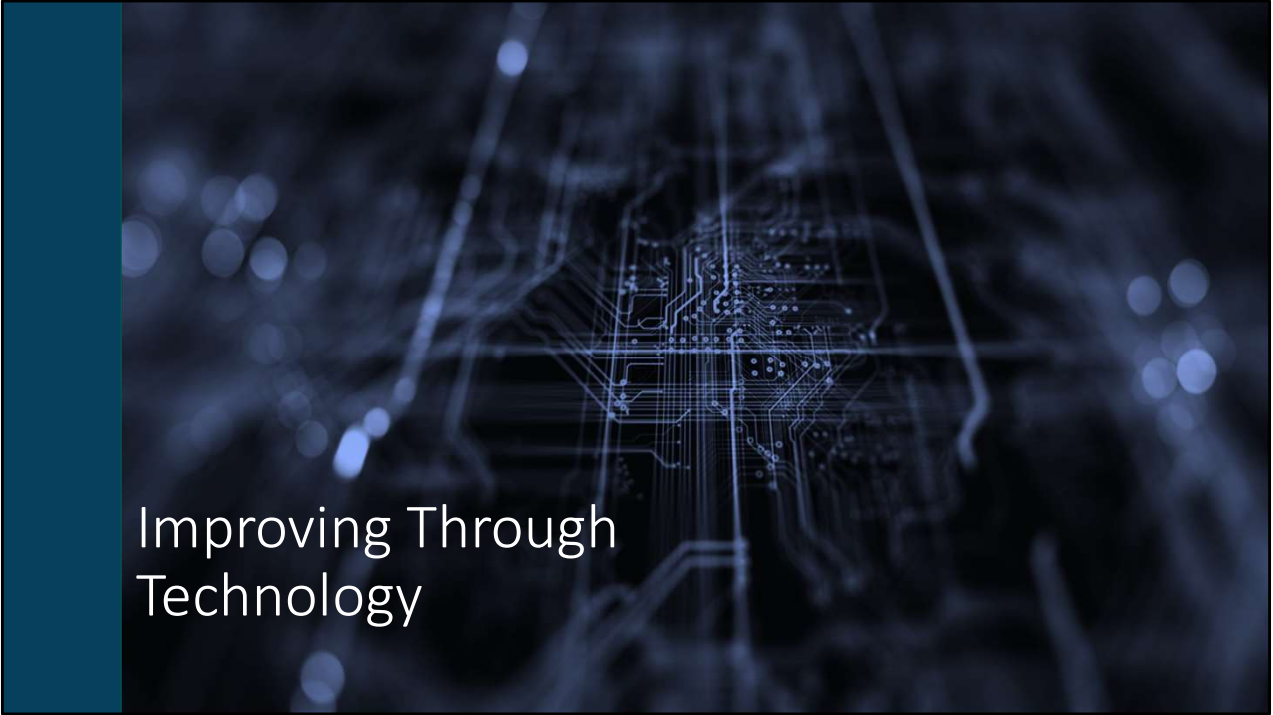


At this stage, only a small group of finalists remains, and all decision-making happens in person.

Hiring managers and HR meet to review candidates together. There is no shared digital system to compare applicants, so discussions rely on interview impressions, handwritten notes, and memory. Each person brings their own paper materials and perspectives into the room. Feedback is exchanged verbally or through notes written on resumes and interview sheets. Because nothing is centralized, information can vary depending on who spoke with the candidate most recently or who took the most detailed notes. Candidates are compared informally rather than through a standardized scoring system. This means decisions are shaped by discussion and consensus rather than structured criteria. While this allows for human judgment, it also makes the process less consistent across roles and departments. Once the group agrees, the selected candidate is identified. Communication with non-selected candidates is not formalized, so many may never receive closure. From the candidate's perspective, the process may simply go silent.

At this stage, the selection process becomes constrained by logistics. Candidate

reviews are dependent on hiring team availability and access to a shared conference space. This can delay decisions even after interviews are complete. When schedules do not align, momentum stalls, and candidates are left waiting. Additionally, feedback is fragmented across handwritten notes, individual recollections, and informal conversations. There is no centralized system to revisit past evaluations. This creates a long-term loss of value. A common recruiting question is whether a candidate is simply not right for this role or not right for the company at all. In ABC's current model, that distinction is often lost. Strong candidates who were not selected may never be reconsidered for future openings because their information is scattered or discarded. The informal nature of evaluation also introduces risk. Without structured criteria, decisions rely heavily on personal impressions. This makes it difficult to surface or correct unconscious bias and can lead to inconsistent outcomes across departments and roles. Finally, the lack of formal disposition communication negatively affects employer branding. Candidates who never hear back are left with a silent experience that feels dismissive or disorganized. Over time, this effects trust in the organization and reduces the likelihood that candidates will reapply, or even recommend ABC to others.



Improving Through Technology

APPLICATION TRACKING SYSTEM (ATS)

"An applicant tracking system (ATS) is an information system designed to support each task of the recruiting process. The ATS provides integrated IT support by embedding all recruiting tasks into a single system and supports the entire recruiting process from the identification of a vacancy to the onboarding of the hired candidate" - (Laumer, et al., 2015, section 3.3, para. 1)



As Laumer et al. (2015) explain, an ATS is not just a digital filing cabinet for resumes. It is an integrated information system designed to support every task in the recruiting process, from identifying a vacancy through onboarding the hired candidate. In other words, it replaces fragmented, paper-based steps with a single, connected workflow. For ABC, this directly addresses the breakdowns we saw in the current process. Instead of sourcing, applications, screening, and selection existing in separate silos, the ATS creates one continuous pipeline. Every candidate enters the same system, moves through the same stages, and remains visible to both HR and hiring managers. Each candidate becomes a living record that follows them from first contact to final decision. Communication, feedback, and status updates are centralized, making the process easier to manage, more consistent, and more transparent. Rather than relying on memory, handwritten notes, and in-person handoffs, ABC gains a structured system that embeds recruiting tasks into a single workflow, exactly as described by Laumer et al. (2015).

ATS: BENEFITS AND DRAWBACKS

(LAUMER, ET AL., 2015)

Benefits

- Centralizes candidates and recruiting activity
- Prevents applicants from being lost or forgotten
- Creates a standardized hiring workflow
- Improves communication through automated workflows
- Enables collaboration between HR and hiring managers
- Reduces time-to-hire by streamlining manual tasks
- Expands sourcing reach through integrated job boards and databases
- Preserves candidate history for future roles

Drawbacks

- Requires upfront cost and implementation effort
- Demands training and process changes for staff
- May feel impersonal to some candidates
- Risk of over-reliance on automation
- Poor configuration can filter out qualified applicants
- AI-based screening may introduce or reinforce bias
- Smaller teams may feel overwhelmed by system complexity

ATS's have both values and tradeoffs of implementing an Applicant Tracking System at ABC, grounded in the research by Laumer et al. (2015). On the benefits side, an ATS centralizes all recruiting activity into a single system. Instead of resumes living in folders, desks, or email inboxes, every candidate becomes part of one shared pipeline. This directly prevents applicants from being lost or forgotten and creates a consistent, standardized hiring workflow across departments. Laumer et al. (2015) show that this kind of integration improves recruiting process performance by reducing fragmentation and handoffs. Automated workflows improve communication with candidates, ensuring confirmations, updates, and dispositions happen reliably rather than depending on memory. The system also enables true collaboration between HR and hiring managers, since everyone works from the same data in real time. By eliminating many manual tasks such as sorting paper, tracking status by hand, and coordinating through email, an ATS reduces time-to-hire. It also expands sourcing reach by integrating with job boards and resume databases, and it preserves candidate history so strong applicants who were not selected can be reconsidered for future roles.

However, these advantages come with important drawbacks. Implementing an ATS requires upfront cost and significant effort. As Laumer et al. (2015) note, the system only delivers value when organizations are willing to redesign their processes around it. Staff must be trained, workflows must change, and resistance to new technology can slow adoption. From the candidate perspective, automated systems may feel impersonal if not implemented thoughtfully. There is also a risk of over-reliance on automation. Poor configuration can filter out qualified applicants, especially when rigid rules or keyword matching are used. When AI-based screening is introduced, it may unintentionally reinforce bias if models are trained on flawed or historical data. Finally, for smaller teams, the complexity of a full ATS can feel overwhelming if the system is not scaled appropriately to organizational needs. ATS is not a magic solution to ABC's current limitations; however, it is a powerful tool that can transform their recruiting process.

TECHNOLOGY FOR SOURCING: RESUME DATABASES

- 1 LinkedIn**
Specializes in white collar business professionals (entry to executive)
- 2 Indeed**
Primarily used for high-volume, entry-level, blue-collar, and operational roles
- 3 Dice**
Go-to place for Information Technology and Analytics professionals
- 4 BuiltIn**
Concentrate of candidates looking to join a business start-up
- 5 ATS**
Leverages previous candidates who have already shown an interest in the organization

A resume database is an online repository of candidate profiles and work histories that can be searched by recruiters. ABC can actively search these databases using filters such as skills, experience level, location, education, or industry. These platforms aggregate millions of resumes and professional profiles which allows organizations to identify qualified candidates who may not have applied but are a strong match for the role.

Each platform serves a different segment of the labor market. LinkedIn is strongest for white-collar and professional roles, ranging from entry-level analysts to senior leaders. It allows recruiters to identify candidates based on career progression, skills, and professional networks, making it ideal for business, management, and knowledge-based roles. Indeed is best suited for high-volume and operational hiring. It is widely used by individuals who are actively seeking work, particularly for entry-level, blue-collar, and frontline positions. This makes it an effective tool when ABC needs to fill roles quickly or in large numbers, such as customer service, warehouse, or production positions. Dice specializes in information technology and analytics professionals. It provides access to candidates with highly technical skill sets that are difficult to reach through general job boards, allowing ABC to target niche talent more

efficiently. BuiltIn attracts candidates who are specifically interested in startup and innovation-focused environments. It is useful for roles that benefit from entrepreneurial mindset, product development, or emerging technology experience. Finally, ABC's own ATS becomes a sourcing tool by storing past applicants who have already shown interest in the organization. Candidates who were not selected for one role can be revisited for future openings, preserving value that is currently lost in the manual process.

RESUME DATABASE BENEFITS AND DRAWBACKS

Benefits

- Expand reach beyond the local market
- Access both active and passive candidates
- Target searches by skills and experience
- Reduce reliance on walk-ins and referrals
- Create a steady talent pipeline
- Accelerate time-to-fill
- Improve role–candidate match quality
- Broaden and diversify the candidate pool

Drawbacks

- Subscription and licensing costs can be significant
- High volume of underqualified or mismatched candidates
- Requires recruiter time to search and filter effectively
- Outreach fatigue among heavily contacted candidates
- Candidate data may be outdated or incomplete
- Overreliance can reduce organic employer brand growth

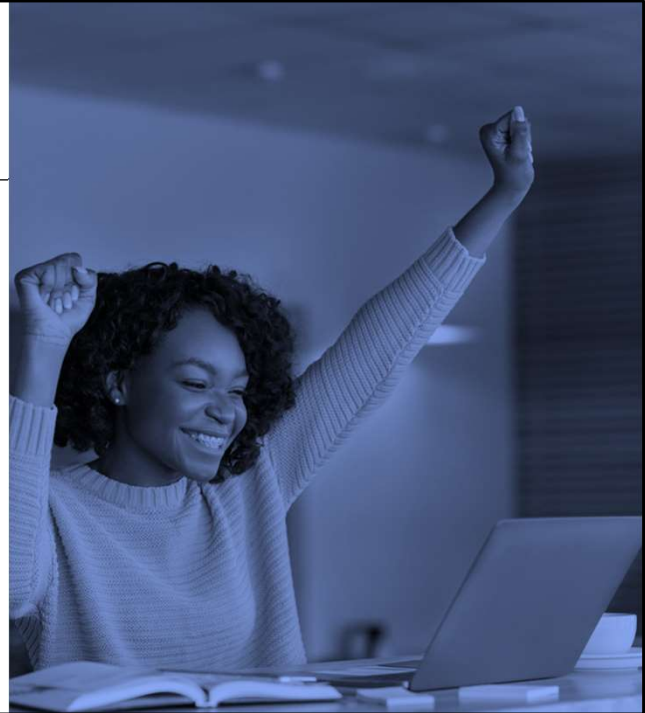
Resume databases changes how organizations attract talent by shifting from a reactive model to a proactive one. Instead of waiting for walk-ins or referrals, ABC can search nationally/globally for candidates who already possess the skills needed for open roles. These platforms provide access to both active job seekers and passive candidates who may not be applying but are open to the right opportunity. Recruiters can run targeted searches by skill, experience level, industry, and location, allowing them to build a steady pipeline rather than starting from zero each time a position opens. This approach reduces reliance on informal sourcing methods and accelerates time-to-fill. Because searches are more precise, the organization can improve role–candidate fit and intentionally broaden and diversify the talent pool. Over time, this creates a more predictable and scalable sourcing strategy.

While resume databases dramatically expand reach, they also introduce meaningful financial barriers. Most platforms operate on a subscription model, and costs can escalate quickly. For example, LinkedIn Recruiter alone is approximately \$1,000 per month for a single recruiter seat (LinkedIn Recruiter, 2025). For small or growing organizations, this represents a significant investment. As a result, leadership must weigh whether the volume and quality

of hires justify the recurring expense. Additionally, resume databases tend to produce a high-volume of underqualified candidates, especially for entry level roles. Recruiters must allocate their time into filtering out these individuals as well as craft outreach to passive candidates. This can result in a significant time investment. Furthermore, candidate profiles can be outdated or incomplete, or sourced candidates might experience outreach fatigue. As a Recruiter in the Public Accounting space, I know that CPA's had at least 10 other recruiters in their inbox hoping they will come work for their firm. Finally, overreliance on databases can weaken organic employer branding. This happens if they neglect community presence, referrals, and direct engagements. Resume databases are a supplement to ABC's already existing sourcing strategy.

TECHNOLOGY FOR APPLYING: DIGITAL APPLICATIONS

- Candidates apply through an online career portal
- Applications are submitted from any device in minutes
- Required fields ensure consistent information
- Pre-screening questions filter basic qualifications
- Candidates receive automatic confirmation
- All applications are stored in a central system



Instead of candidates relying on walk-ins, mailed resumes, or informal handoffs, applicants submit their information through a single online career portal. This portal is accessible from any device, allowing candidates to apply from home, on their phone, or while searching on a job board. The entire process can be completed in just a few minutes. Each application follows the same structure. Required fields ensure that every candidate provides consistent information such as contact details, work history, and availability. This replaces handwritten forms that vary in quality and completeness. Pre-screening questions are built directly into the application. These questions check for baseline requirements like certifications, location, or schedule availability before the application is fully submitted. This creates an initial layer of screening at the point of entry. Once submitted, the system automatically confirms receipt so candidates know their application was successfully received. Every application is stored in a central system, giving recruiters and hiring managers immediate visibility without relying on paper files, email chains, or verbal handoffs.

DIGITAL APPLICATIONS: BENEFITS AND DRAWBACKS

Benefits

- Removes barriers to applying
- Increases application volume and reach
- Creates consistent candidate experience
- Ensures standardized information
- Reduces lost or misplaced applications
- Speeds up recruiter review
- Improves communication
- Builds researchable talent pools

Drawbacks

- Increase volume of low-quality candidates
- Can feel impersonal compared to in-person interactions
- Upfront setup and ongoing system maintenance
- Staff training and process changes
- Risk of over-filtering
- Technical issues can disrupt application process

Digital applications dramatically improve how candidates engage with the hiring process. By removing physical and logistical barriers, it allows candidates to apply from any device in minutes. This results in expanding reach and increases overall application volume. It creates a more consistent candidate experience as every applicant moves through the same process. From the organization's perspective, digital intake reduces the risk of lost or misplaced applications, accelerates recruiter review, and enables faster follow-up through automated confirmations and status updates. As mentioned prior, these applications also form a searchable talent pool which allows ABC to revisit strong candidates for future roles instead of starting from scratch each time.

However, these benefits come with tradeoffs. Making it easier to apply often increases the volume of mismatched candidates. In turn, this requires more time and effort to filter effectively. The process can also affect how some candidates perceive the organization as it can feel impersonal compared to in-person interactions. Additionally, implementing a digital application system requires upfront setup, staff training, and ongoing technical support. Any system downtime or configuration errors can disrupt the application flow. Finally, poorly designed prescreening questions or filters risk excluding qualified applicants

before a human ever reviews them.



TECHNOLOGY FOR SCREENING: AI-ASSISTED REVIEW

- Resumes and applications are automatically parsed and digitized
- The system flags candidates who meet baseline qualifications
- Recruiters receive a prioritized list instead of unsorted files
- Built-in phone and video tools support remote pre-screen interviews
- Screening notes are entered directly into the system
- All reviewer feedback is stored in one shared workspace

(Murugesan et al., 2023; Upadhyay & Khandelwal, 2018)

AI-assisted screening transforms ABC's manual, paper-based review into a structured and technology-enabled process. Instead of managers sorting through stacks of resumes, applications are automatically parsed and digitized the moment they enter the system. This converts unstructured documents into searchable data, allowing recruiters to work from a single, organized pipeline (Murugesan et al., 2023). The system then applies baseline qualification rules, such as required certifications, minimum experience, or availability, and flags candidates who meet those criteria. Rather than replacing human judgment, the AI acts as a triage layer that helps surface relevant candidates faster and more consistently (Upadhyay & Khandelwal, 2018). Recruiters no longer begin with a pile of unsorted files. They receive a prioritized list that reflects job-related criteria. Built-in phone and video tools also change how screening conversations occur. Instead of relying on in-person meetings or missed phone tags, recruiters can schedule and conduct pre-screen interviews directly within the system. This is especially valuable when candidates are not local or when managers have limited availability. Finally, every screening note and piece of feedback is entered into the system and stored in a shared workspace. This eliminates the fragmentation ABC experiences today, where information is handwritten, scattered, or lost. All reviewers can see the same history, ensuring continuity

across roles and allowing candidates to be reconsidered for future opportunities. Together, these features shift screening from an informal, inconsistent process into a structured, collaborative, and data-supported workflow (Murugesan et al., 2023; Upadhyay & Khandelwal, 2018).

AI-ASSISTED REVIEW: BENEFITS AND DRAWBACKS

Benefits

- Speeds up resume review and reducing manual workload
- Applies the same baseline criteria to every applicant
- Helps recruiters focus on qualified candidates first
- Enables faster movement through early hiring stages
- Centralizes feedback and notes
- Supports remote pre-screening via integrated phone and video tools
- Enhances collaboration

(Murugesan et al., 2023; Upadhyay & Khandelwal, 2018)

Drawbacks

- Reduces complex individuals to scores, oversimplifying human potential
- Cannot evaluate soft skills, growth potential, or cultural fit
- Can replicate and amplify historical gender and racial bias
- Proven preference for white-associated names in screening tools
- Bias reflects training data: “garbage in, garbage out”
- Limited transparency in how decisions are made Lack of audits allows biased outcomes to persist

(Binns et al., 2018; Wilson & Caliskan, 2024; Bogen & Rieke, 2018)

AI-assisted screening automates early-stage resume review by parsing applications, identifying key qualifications, and prioritizing candidates who meet baseline requirements. This significantly reduces manual workload and speeds up the screening process (Murugesan et al., 2023). By applying the same criteria to every applicant, these systems introduce procedural consistency that is difficult to achieve in fully human-driven review (Upadhyay & Khandelwal, 2018). Recruiters receive a ranked list rather than an unsorted stack of resumes, allowing them to focus first on the most relevant candidates and move more quickly through early hiring stages. These tools also centralize notes and feedback, improving collaboration between recruiters and hiring managers. Integrated phone and video features further streamline screening by enabling remote pre-screen interviews, reducing scheduling and geographic barriers (Upadhyay & Khandelwal, 2018).

Despite these advantages, AI screening introduces serious risks. Algorithmic systems can reduce complex individuals to scores and oversimplifying human potential (Binns et al., 2018). They struggle to evaluate soft skills such as adaptability, growth potential, and cultural fit. More concerning, AI can replicate and amplify historical bias when trained on past data. Wilson and Caliskan

(2024) found that popular screening tools favored white-associated names and disproportionately disadvantaged Black candidates. This reflects the “garbage in, garbage out” problem, where biased data produces biased outcomes. Finally, many AI systems lack transparency. Organizations may not fully understand how decisions are made, and without audits, biased outcomes can persist unchecked (Bogen & Rieke, 2018). For this reason, AI-assisted review should support, not replace, human judgment and must be paired with oversight and accountability.

TECHNOLOGY FOR SELECTION: CENTRALIZED DECISION TOOLS

- Feedback is submitted through standardized digital forms
- Candidate evaluations are stored in a shared workspace
- Candidates compared side-by-side in one system
- Scorecards ensure consistent evaluation criteria
- Comment/ratings are (only) visible to HR and hiring managers
- Final decisions are documented and auditable



In ABC's current process, selection happens through informal conversation, handwritten notes, and manager judgment. Feedback is scattered across people and paper. Once a role is filled, there is no reliable way to revisit why a candidate was passed over or whether they might fit a future role. With a centralized digital selection system, every interviewer submits feedback through structured scorecards inside the ATS. Notes, ratings, and comments are captured in one shared workspace. Hiring managers and HR can view feedback in real time and compare candidates side by side. This shifts selection from a fragmented process to a structured one. Decisions are still made by people, but they are supported by organized data. The system does not choose the candidate. It provides a consistent framework for discussion. Instead of asking, "Who did we like best?" the team can ask, "How does each candidate compare across the same criteria?" The final decision is documented and traceable. Strong candidates can also be revisited for future roles.

CENTRALIZED DECISION TOOLS: BENEFITS AND DRAWBACKS

Benefits

- Consistent and fair evaluation process
- Centralizes all interviewer feedback
- Enables side-by-side candidate comparison
- Reduces reliance on memory and informal discussion
- Improves transparency and accountability in decisions
- Preserves candidate history for future opportunities
- Strengthens collaboration between HR and hiring managers

Drawbacks

- Requires training and time for managers to adopt to new workflow
- Can feel rigid compared to informal decisions
- Risk of over-standardizing roles that require subjective judgment
- May slow decisions
- Poorly designed scorecards can misrepresent candidate strengths
- Technology issues
- Overreliance on structure may reduce human intuition

This slide focuses on how centralized decision tools change the final hiring decision itself.

On the benefits side, the biggest shift is consistency. Every candidate is evaluated using the same criteria which creates a fairer process and reduces the influence of memory, first impressions, or unconscious bias. All interviewer feedback is stored in one place, so nothing is lost in side conversations or handwritten notes. Hiring teams can compare candidates side by side, rather than relying on who spoke most recently or most confidently in a meeting. This also improves transparency, accountability, and compliance. Decisions are documented and the rationale is visible. If a strong candidate is not selected, their profile and feedback are preserved for future roles. HR and hiring managers are no longer working from different sets of information. Everyone is aligned in the same system.

The drawbacks reflect the tradeoff between structure and flexibility. Managers need time and training to adapt to a new workflow. What once felt fast and informal can now feel rigid. For roles that depend heavily on subjective judgment, standardized scorecards can feel limiting. Poorly designed evaluation

forms may fail to capture a candidate's real strengths. There is also the risk that teams slow down because they over-rely on forms and process. Technology issues can interrupt decision timelines. Finally, if teams treat the system as a replacement for judgment rather than a support tool, they may lose the human intuition that still matters in hiring.

QUESTIONS?

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